Radio Standards

WS 2026

Lorenz Mohr, Dr.-Ing. Alexander Ihlow, Prof. Thomas Dallmann

Fachgebiet Elektronische Messtechnik und Signalverarbeitung (EMS)

Technische Universität Ilmenau

1. Introduction

Organization

Lecture
Takes place on Mondays, 03:00 pm - 04:30 pm, in OEC3008 (except winter break)

Tutorial

- Takes place on Tuesdays, 11:00 am - 12:30 pm, in OEC3008 (except winter break)
- No tutorial in the classical sense, instead three group presentations about selected standards
- Learn to understand standards and improve presentation skills
- Topic and group selection via moodle (deadline next lecture)
- Digital video broadcasting (DVB), 0G-5G, WiFi, and Bluetooth not selectable, will be covered in this lecture
- Feel free to suggest interesting standards by yourself

Prerequisites

- Signal and system theory
- Basic engineering math

Lecture Material

- Please enroll in the Moodle course
- Lecture script will grow throughout the semester

Exam Regulations

Exam

- **30 min** oral exam
- Standards presented by your groups will be part of the exam

Bonus Points

Presentations give bonus points for the exam

Maximum: One-third grade step

e.g. $2.7 \rightarrow 2.3$, $1.3 \rightarrow 1.0$

Overall Goal

How to work with standards

Understand why standards exist	How to read them	How to understand them (on technical level)	How to make use of them

Electronic Measurements and Signal Processing Group EMS

We investigate the behavior of radio propagation channels and develop methods to make them usable.







- Development of measurement equipment for characterizing radio channels from 0 Hz to 300 GHz
- Measurement, simulation, and modeling of radio channels
- Analysis of radio channel characteristics using signal processing - high-resolution estimation methods and AI

- Exploitation of radio channel characteristics for environmental sensing - radar technology and integrated communications and sensing (ICAS)
- Emulation of electromagnetic wave propagation for testing mobile and satellite communications
- Standardization and development of solutions relevant to mobile communications standards

Radio Standards several decades ago...

... by Dr.-Ing. Alexander Ihlow

Topics to be Covered I

1. Technical Preliminaries
   - LTI Channel
   - Fourier Transformation
   - Spatial Processing
2. Standardization 101
   - How is the electromagnetic spectrum occupied?
   - What is a standard?
   - What is a standardization body?
   - What is a patent?
3. Propagation in a Nutshell (by Alexander Ihlow)
   - How do cable, satellite, and air interfaces differ from each other?
4. Evolution of Cellular Standards
   - 0G-2G
   - 3G
   - Deep dive OFDM
   - 4G
   - 5G

Topics to be Covered II

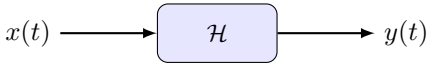
5. WiFi vs. Bluetooth vs. Cellular
   - Why do we have different standards for different applications and use cases?
6. Hands-on DVB (by Alexander Ihlow)
   - How to read a standard?
7. Business Models
   - How to commercialize a standard?
8. The Future of Mobile Communications
   - 6G and beyond
   - Trends and goals
   - Recent research at EMS

2. Preliminaries

Technical Preliminaries

LTI System Model

Channel as Block Model



- System operator $\mathcal{H}$
- Transforms input signal $x(t)$ to output signal $y(t)$

System Operator under linear time-invariant (LTI) Properties

- **L**inear
  - $\mathcal{H}\{\alpha x_1(t) + \beta x_2(t)\} = \alpha\mathcal{H}\{x_1(t)\} + \beta\mathcal{H}\{x_2(t)\}$
  - Superposition principle
- **T**ime **I**nvariant
  - $\mathcal{H}\{x(t-\tau)\} = y(t-\tau)$
  - Time delay τ of input equates to time delay τ of output

Remark: Real channels are inherently dynamic—covered in lecture 2 (coherence time)

Channel channel impulse response (CIR)

Response to an ideal Dirac pulse $\delta(t)$

$$h(t) = \mathcal{H}\{\delta(t)\}$$

LTI Input-Output Relation

Convolution of input $x(t)$ with CIR $h(t)$

$$y(t) = x(t) * h(t)$$

$$y(t) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x(\tau)h(t-\tau)\,\mathrm{d}\tau$$

Fourier Transformation I

From Impulse Response to Transfer Function

- Time-domain CIR $h(t)$ describes channel delay behavior
- Fourier transform (FT) maps CIR to frequency domain channel transfer function (CTF)
- $h(t) \circ\!\!-\!\!\bullet\, H(f)$

Basis Functions & Eigenfunction Property

- Complex exponentials $\phi_f(t) = \mathrm{e}^{\mathrm{j}2\pi ft}$ serve as orthogonal basis (kernel)
- Exponentials pass through unchanged except for complex scaling
- $\mathcal{H}\{\mathrm{e}^{\mathrm{j}2\pi ft}\} = H(f) \cdot \mathrm{e}^{\mathrm{j}2\pi ft}$
- Complex scalar $H(f)$ gives channel attenuation and phase rotation at frequency f

FT (Analysis)

Decomposition into spectrum

$$H(f) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} h(t)\, \mathrm{e}^{-\mathrm{j}2\pi ft}\, \mathrm{d}t$$

inverse Fourier transform (IFT) (Synthesis)

Reconstruction of time signal

$$h(t) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} H(f)\, \mathrm{e}^{\mathrm{j}2\pi ft}\, \mathrm{d}f$$

Orthonormality of Complex Exponentials

$$\left\langle \mathrm{e}^{\mathrm{j}2\pi f_1 t}, \mathrm{e}^{\mathrm{j}2\pi f_2 t} \right\rangle = \delta(f_1 - f_2)$$

Fourier Transformation II

Time-Frequency Uncertainty

- Direct consequence of the FT scaling property
- $x(at) \circ\!\!-\!\!\bullet\ \frac{1}{|a|} X\left(\frac{f}{a}\right)$
- Narrow time duration $\implies$ wide spectral occupancy
- Time-limited signals can never be strictly band-limited

Impact on Radio Standards

- Sharp transitions (e.g., rect pulse) cause slow $1/f$ spectral decay
- High sidelobes leak energy thereby causing interference
- Regulatory spectral masks strictly limit out-of-band emissions

Remark: An optimal pulse must balance finite duration and low spectral sidelobes—covered in lecture 2 (root-raised-cosine)

FT Example

$$\mathrm{rect}\left(\tfrac{t}{T}\right) \circ\!\!-\!\!\bullet\ T\,\mathrm{si}(\pi f T)$$

$$\mathrm{si}(x) = \frac{\sin(x)}{x}, \text{ zeros at } f = \pm\frac{k}{T}$$

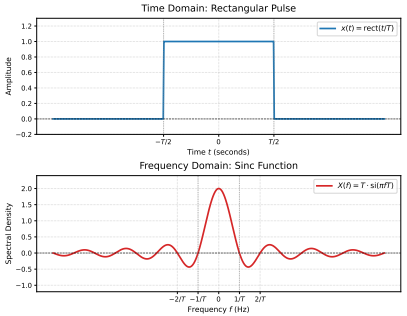


Figure: Rectangular Pulse and Si Function

Fourier Transformation III

Live demo: Frequency spectrum from the computer microphone

- scripts/section-1/live-spectrogram.py

Fourier Transformation IV

Essential Fourier Properties

- Time Shifting (e.g. Propagation Delay)
  - $x(t-\tau_0) \;\circ\!\!-\!\!\bullet\; X(f)\,\mathrm{e}^{-\mathrm{j}2\pi f\tau_0}$
  - Delay τ_0 introduces a linear phase rotation across frequency
- Frequency Shifting (e.g. Doppler Shift)
  - $x(t)\,\mathrm{e}^{\mathrm{j}2\pi f_\mathrm{D} t} \;\circ\!\!-\!\!\bullet\; X(f-f_\mathrm{D})$
  - Doppler shift f_D introduces linear phase rotation across time
- Convolution Theorem
  - $x(t) * h(t) \;\circ\!\!-\!\!\bullet\; X(f)\cdot H(f)$
  - Simplifies channel equalization from deconvolution to division
- Sampling / Periodicity Duality
  - Periodicity t/f $\Longleftrightarrow$ Sampling f/t

$$\underbrace{x_\mathrm{s}(t) = x(t)\cdot\sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty}\delta(t-nT_\mathrm{s})}_{\text{Sampling in Time}} \quad \circ\!\!-\!\!\bullet \quad \underbrace{X_\mathrm{s}(f) = \frac{1}{T_\mathrm{s}}\sum_{k=-\infty}^{\infty} X\left(f-\frac{k}{T_\mathrm{s}}\right)}_{\text{Periodification in Frequency}}$$

Complex Baseband I

Why Complex Signals for Real Waves?

- Antennas emit and capture real-valued signals $s_{\mathrm{BP}}(t) \in \mathbb{R}$
- Communications signals usually narrowband ($B \ll f_{\mathrm{c}}$)
  - Carrier f_{c} fixed in the GHz regime (e.g., $3.5\,\mathrm{GHz}$)
  - Information encoded in amplitude $A(t)$ and phase $\phi(t)$
- Simulating carrier oscillations at GHz rates is computationally expensive

Equivalent Complex baseband (BB) Envelope

- Utilize complex numbers to combine amplitude and phase
- $s_{\mathrm{BB}}(t) = A(t)\,\mathrm{e}^{\mathrm{j}\phi(t)} \in \mathbb{C}$
- Describes signal independent of the carrier frequency

Bandpass-baseband transformation

Bandpass (BP) as real projection of BB signal

$$s_{\mathrm{BP}}(t) = \mathrm{Re}\Big\{ s_{\mathrm{BB}}(t)\,\mathrm{e}^{\mathrm{j}2\pi f_{\mathrm{c}} t} \Big\}$$

Advantages

- Spectrum centered around $0\,\mathrm{Hz}$
- Sample rate reduces from $2(f_{\mathrm{c}} + B/2)$ to B
- Clean mathematical framework for modulation and filtering

Complex Baseband II

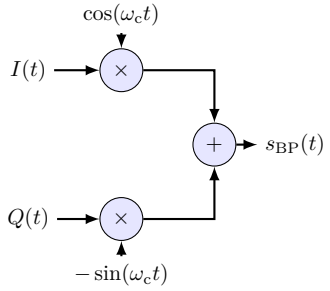
Cartesian Decomposition of BB

- Split complex envelope into real and imaginary parts:
- $s_{\mathrm{BB}}(t) = I(t) + \mathrm{j}Q(t)$
- $I(t) = \mathrm{Re}\{s_{\mathrm{BB}}(t)\} = A(t)\cos\phi(t)$ (**In-Phase**)
- $Q(t) = \mathrm{Im}\{s_{\mathrm{BB}}(t)\} = A(t)\sin\phi(t)$ (**Quadrature**)

Orthogonal Carrier Modulation

- Expanding $s_{\mathrm{BP}}(t)$ with Euler's identity
- $\mathrm{e}^{\mathrm{j}2\pi f_c t} = \cos\omega_c t + \mathrm{j}\sin\omega_c t$
- $s_{\mathrm{BP}}(t) = I(t)\cos(2\pi f_c t) - Q(t)\sin(2\pi f_c t)$
- Transmits two independent data streams over the same RF spectrum

in-phase and quadrature (I/Q) Modulator Architecture



Why do we have Digital Communication Systems?

Disadvantages of Analog Systems

- Requires two physical signal traces for I and Q
- Analog hardware impairments

Advantages of Digital Systems

- Complex numbers handled in memory/software
- Flexibility of the hardware platforms (Software-defined radio)
- Conditional access and encryption
- Error correction and information compression
- Storage of digital data

Discrete Fourier Transformation I

Discrete Counterpart of the FT

- The discrete Fourier transform (DFT) maps N discrete time samples to N discrete frequency bins
- DFT kernel from FT kernel
- $\mathrm{e}^{-\mathrm{j}2\pi ft} \quad \longrightarrow \quad \mathrm{e}^{-\mathrm{j}\frac{2\pi}{N}kn} = W_N^{kn}$
- Discrete complex exponentials $\phi_k[n] = \mathrm{e}^{\mathrm{j}\frac{2\pi kn}{N}}$ serve as orthogonal basis

Intrinsic Periodicity of the DFT

- Discrete harmonic basis is N-periodic
- $W_N^{(k+N)n} = W_N^{kn} \implies X[k+N] = X[k]$
- Time sequence implicitly treated as periodic
- $\tilde{x}[n] = x[n \bmod N]$

N-Point DFT (Analysis)

Time sequence to discrete frequency

$$X[k] = \sum_{n=0}^{N-1} x[n]\, \mathrm{e}^{-\mathrm{j}\frac{2\pi}{N}kn}$$

$$k \in \{0, 1, \ldots, N-1\}$$

N-Point inverse discrete Fourier transform (IDFT) (Synthesis)

Reconstruction of time samples

$$x[n] = \tfrac{1}{N} \sum_{k=0}^{N-1} X[k]\, \mathrm{e}^{\mathrm{j}\frac{2\pi}{N}kn}$$

$$n \in \{0, 1, \ldots, N-1\}$$

Orthogonality of Discrete Complex Exponentials

$$\left\langle \mathrm{e}^{\mathrm{j}\frac{2\pi kn}{N}}, \mathrm{e}^{\mathrm{j}\frac{2\pi mn}{N}} \right\rangle = \begin{cases} N, & k = m \\ 0, & k \neq m \end{cases}$$

Discrete Fourier Transformation II

- Time Shifting
  - Compare to FT (Slide 2.7)
  - $x\left[(n - n_0) \bmod N\right] = X[k]\, e^{-j\frac{2\pi}{N}kn_0}$
- Frequency Shifting
  - Compare to FT (Slide 2.7)
  - $X\left[(k - k_0) \bmod N\right] = x[n]\, e^{j\frac{2\pi}{N}k_0 n}$
- Convolution Discrepancy Compared to FT
  - Discrete LTI channels perform linear convolution
  - $y[n] = x[n] * h[n] = \sum_m h[m]x[n-m]$
  - Multiplying two DFTs yields circular convolution ($\circledast_N$)
  - $x[n] \circledast_N h[n] \circ\!\!-\!\!\bullet\, X[k] \cdot H[k]$

Circular Convolution $\circledast_N$

$$x[n] \circledast_N h[n] = \sum_{m=0}^{N-1} h[m]\, x[(n-m) \bmod N]$$

Discrete Fourier Transformation III

DFT is a linear transformation

- N-point DFT acts as matrix-vector product:

$$\mathbf{X} = \mathbf{F}_N \mathbf{x}$$

- $\mathbf{x} = [x[0], \ldots, x[N-1]]^T \in \mathbb{C}^N$
- $\mathbf{X} = [X[0], \ldots, X[N-1]]^T \in \mathbb{C}^N$
- $\mathbf{F}_N$ is a symmetric matrix with entries $[\mathbf{F}_N]_{k,n} = W_N^{k \cdot n}$

Orthogonality & IDFT

- Columns of $\mathbf{F}_N$ form an orthogonal basis:

$$\mathbf{F}_N^{\mathrm{H}} \mathbf{F}_N = N \mathbf{I}_N \implies \mathbf{F}_N^{-1} = \frac{1}{N} \mathbf{F}_N^{\mathrm{H}}$$

- IDFT matrix is conjugate transpose $\mathbf{F}_N^{\mathrm{H}}$ scaled by $1/N$

The DFT Matrix $\mathbf{F}_N$

$$\mathbf{F}_N = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 1 & \ldots & 1 \\ 1 & W_N^1 & W_N^2 & \ldots & W_N^{N-1} \\ 1 & W_N^2 & W_N^4 & \ldots & W_N^{2(N-1)} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ 1 & W_N^{N-1} & W_N^{2(N-1)} & \ldots & W_N^{(N-1)^2} \end{bmatrix}$$

- With $W_N = \mathrm{e}^{-\mathrm{j}\frac{2\pi}{N}}$

Matrix-vector representation

- $\mathbf{X} = \mathbf{F}_N \mathbf{x}$
- $\mathbf{x} = \frac{1}{N} \mathbf{F}_N^{\mathrm{H}} \mathbf{X}$

Spatial Processing I

- Plane wave = oscillation across distance and time
- Wave number k_0 = spatial phase velocity per meter $(\mathrm{rad/m})$
- Wave vector k = directional vector pointing along direction of propagation θ
- Spatial sampling = antenna elements sample positions as analog-to-digital converter (ADC)s sample time
- Time–frequency duality maps to space–angle

Wave Basics

- Wave propagation in space and time
- $s(\mathbf{r}, t) = \mathrm{e}^{\mathrm{j}(\omega t - \mathbf{k}\cdot\mathbf{r})}$
- Spatial frequency vector
- $||\mathbf{k}||_2 = k_0 = \frac{2\pi}{\lambda}$

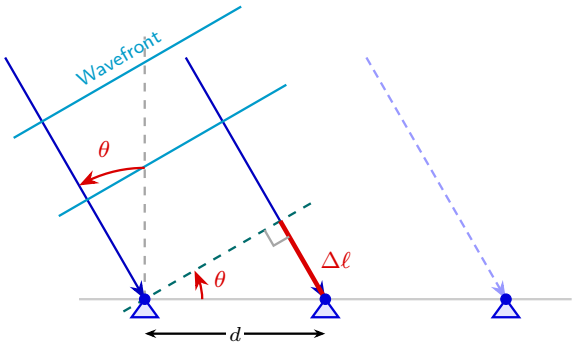
Time–Space Duality

Time Domain	**Spatial Domain**
Time t	Position x
Period T_s	Element Spacing d
Freq. ω	Wavenumber k_0
$f_\mathrm{s} \geq 2B$	$d \leq \lambda/2$

Spatial Processing II

Uniform linear array (ULA)

- Plane wave arriving from angle θ
- Wave travels extra Δl per element
- Elements experience angle-dependent phase shift ψ compared to reference element 0
- Array steering vector $\mathbf{a}(\theta)$
- $\mathbf{a}(\theta) = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & \mathrm{e}^{-\mathrm{j}\psi} & \dots & \mathrm{e}^{-\mathrm{j}(M-1)\psi} \end{bmatrix}^T$
- Spatial sampling without ambiguities if $d \leq \frac{\lambda}{2} \iff |\psi| \leq \pi$



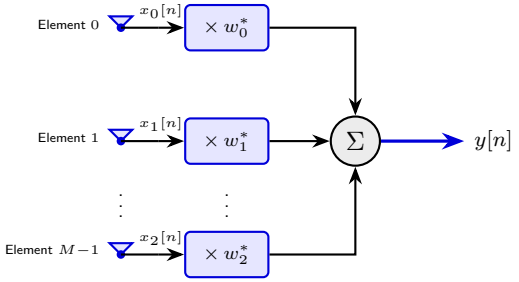
Path difference: $\Delta\ell = d \sin\theta$

Phase shift: $\psi = \frac{2\pi}{\lambda}\Delta\ell = \frac{2\pi d}{\lambda}\sin\theta$

Spatial Processing III

Bartlett Beamformer

- Weight vector $\mathbf{w}(\theta)$ "steers" antenna array
- Maximizes output power for direction θ by selecting weights as
- $\mathbf{w}_{\text{Bartlett}}(\theta) = \frac{1}{M}\mathbf{a}(\theta)$
- Undo phase shifts introduced by channel
- Scan output power of beamformer across θ
- $P_{\text{BF}}(\theta) = \mathbf{w}^H(\theta)\,\mathbf{R}_{xx}\,\mathbf{w}(\theta)$



Output Signal Model

- Snapshot vector: $\mathbf{x}[n] = \mathbf{a}(\theta_0)s[n] + \mathbf{n}[n]$
- Beamformer output: $y[n] = \mathbf{w}^H(\theta)\mathbf{x}[n]$
- Spatial covariance: $\mathbf{R}_{xx} = \mathbb{E}\{\mathbf{x}[n]\mathbf{x}^H[n]\}$

Spatial Processing IV

Live demo: Bartlett beamformer visualization

- scripts/section-1/bartlett.py
- scripts/section-1/bartlett-multi-doa.py

Standardization Preliminaries

Radio Spectrum

What is the Radio Spectrum?

- Part of electromagnetic spectrum from $3\,\mathrm{Hz}$ to $3\,\mathrm{THz}$
- Finite natural resource used for wireless communication
- Backbone of modern telecommunication and broadcasting

Spectrum Allocation

- Globally coordinated by International Telecommunication Union (ITU)
- Divided into frequency bands assigned to specific services (TV, radio, mobile, satellite, radar, amateur)

Frequency vs. Wavelength

- Connection between frequency f and wavelength λ
- $c = \lambda \cdot f$
- $c = 299\,792\,458\,\mathrm{m\,s^{-1}}$ (in vacuum)

Rules-of-Thumb

- $1\,\mathrm{GHz} \rightarrow 30\,\mathrm{cm}$
- $3\,\mathrm{GHz} \rightarrow 10\,\mathrm{cm}$
- $10\,\mathrm{GHz} \rightarrow 3\,\mathrm{cm}$

Radio Spectrum by ITU

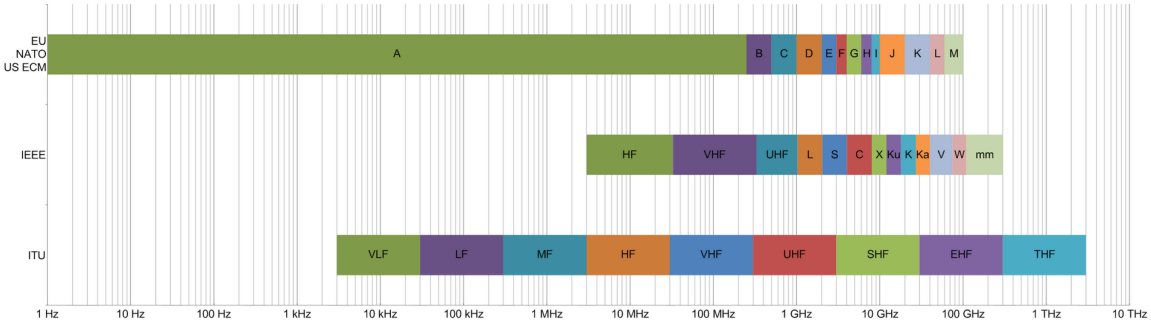


Figure: Radio Spectrum and ITU Frequency Bands [1]

Radio Spectrum Allocation USA

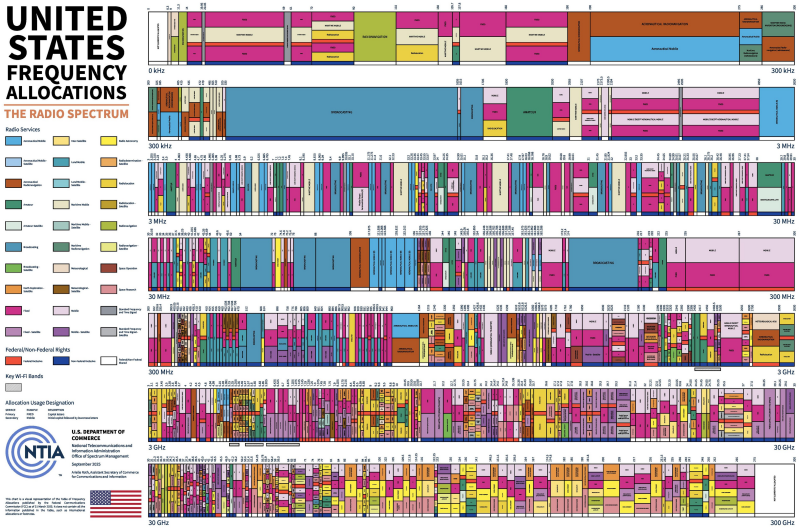


Figure: Radio Spectrum Allocation USA [2]

Allocation Example I

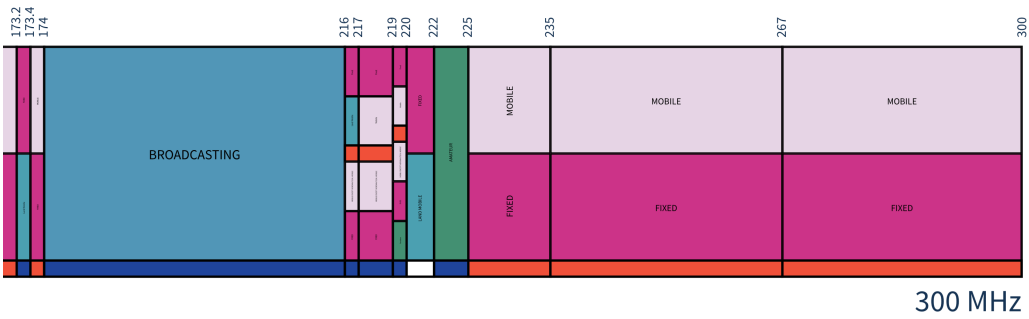


Figure: Radio Spectrum Allocation USA @300 MHz [2]

- Broadcasting starting @174 MHz: TV Channels
- Fixed/mobile starting @225 MHz: Military Band
  - Primary military (e.g., air-to-air/air-to-ground voice)
  - Aeronnautical radionavigation (instrument landing system (ILS) vertical guidance)

Allocation Example II

Frequency band $2.4\,\text{GHz}$ to $2.5\,\text{GHz}$

- Industrial, scientific and medical (ISM) band
  - High-power non-communication emitters (e.g., microwave ovens, industrial heating and drying)
  - Source of interference
- Unlicensed wireless systems
  - e.g., Wi-Fi, Bluetooth
  - Must tolerate ISM interference

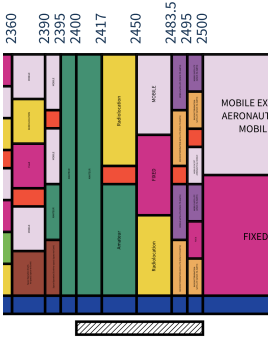


Figure: Radio Spectrum Allocation USA @$2.4\,\text{GHz}$ [2]

ITU

- United Nations Specialized Agency for Information and Communications Technology
- Founded in 1865 as the International Telegraph Union
- Renamed in 1947 to International Telecommunication Union
- Coordinates global use of the radio spectrum
- In total 194 member states
- Each member state has equal representation and voting rights e.g., on standards

ITU's three sectors

- ITU-R (Radio): Radio spectrum management, satellite coordination
- ITU-T (Telecommunication): Technical standards (Recommendations)
- ITU-D (Development): Digital development in member states

Standards

- Ensures fit for purpose, safe, and reliable products/services
- Promotes interoperability between equipment
- Harmonizes trade requirements across the globe
- Eliminates technical barriers
- Remark: Standards are adopted by mutual consensus; some become legally binding through regulatory reference (e.g., European Telecommunications Standards Institute (ETSI) standards cited in European Union (EU) law—USB-C in the EU common charger directive)

What is a standard?

A standard is an agreed-upon, repeatable technical specification or guideline designed to ensure that materials, products, processes, and services are safe, reliable, and mutually interoperable.

Key characteristics of radio standards

- Consensus-based: agreed by all parties
- Documented: published and accessible
- Voluntary: adoption is typically optional
- Continuously updated: revised as technology evolves

Standardization Bodies I

Standardization bodies develop, approve, and publish standards.

- International bodies
  - Coordinate global standards
  - e.g., International Organization for Standardization (ISO) (from Greek *isos*: equal)
  - e.g., ITU
- Regional bodies
  - Cover large geographic areas
  - e.g., ETSI
- National bodies
  - Represent each country
  - e.g., Deutsches Institut für Normung (DIN)
  - e.g., American National Standards Institute (ANSI)
- Industry consortia
  - Cover specific sectors
  - e.g., 3rd Generation Partnership Project (3GPP)
  - e.g., Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE)

Role of industry consortia

- Standards of big alliances are directly adopted into official frameworks
- Consortium defines specs → adopted as regional standard → recognized globally
- e.g., Cellular standard (5G NR)

3GPP (TS 38.211)
↓
ETSI (TS 138 211)
↓
ITU-R (IMT-2020)

Standardization Bodies II

IEEE

- Global professional association
- Develops technical standards for electronics and computing
- e.g., IEEE 802.11 (Wi-Fi), 802.3 (Ethernet), 754 (floating-point)

ISO

- Network of national standards bodies
- Develops international standards across all industries
- e.g., ISO 9001 (quality), ISO 27001 (security), ISO/International Electrotechnical Commission (IEC) 14443 (RFID/NFC)

DIN

- German national standards body
- Representative for ISO/IEC
- DIN A4 paper, DIN 7258 (screws)

3GPP

- Collaboration of telecommunications standards organizations
- Develops specifications for mobile networks
- e.g., 3G, 4G, 5G, 6G

Standardization Process I

Types of standardization process

- Emergence as de facto standard (e.g., Ethernet)
- Written by standards organization (e.g., IEEE 802.11)
- Written by government or regulatory body (e.g., Federal Communications Commission (FCC) rules)
- Written by a corporation (e.g., Apple Lightning connector)

Standardize standards

The process of standardization can itself be standardized (e.g., ISO/IEC Directives Part 1/2).

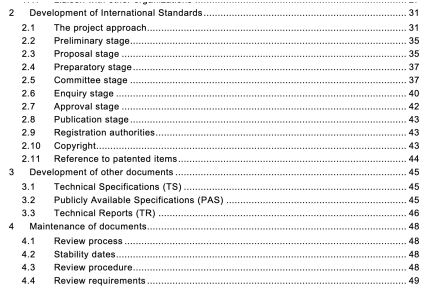

2 Development of International Standards ... 31
2.1 The project approach ... 31
2.2 Preliminary stage ... 35
2.3 Proposal stage ... 35
2.4 Preparatory stage ... 37
2.5 Committee stage ... 37
2.6 Enquiry stage ... 40
2.7 Approval stage ... 42
2.8 Publication stage ... 43
2.9 Registration authorities ... 43
2.10 Copyright ... 43
2.11 Reference to patented items ... 44
3 Development of other documents ... 45
3.1 Technical Specifications (TS) ... 45
3.2 Publicly Available Specifications (PAS) ... 45
3.3 Technical Reports (TR) ... 46
4 Maintenance of documents ... 48
4.1 Review process ... 48
4.2 Stability dates ... 48
4.3 Review procedure ... 48
4.4 Review requirements ... 49

Figure: Excerpt from ISO/IEC Directives Part 1 [3]

Standardization Process II

Standards are versioned through releases, e.g., 3GPP

Release 8 (Long Term Evolution (LTE))
↓
Release 15 (5G)
↓
Release 21 (6G)

- Each release adds new features, fixes, and deprecations
- Industry coordinates on specific release versions
- Development can take years (especially for international bodies)
- Requires broad stakeholder participation
- Iterative process with multiple review rounds

Standardization Process (simplified)

1. Propose new topic or revision
2. Form working group of experts
3. Draft, review, and refine the specification
4. Achieve consensus and publish
5. Maintain and periodically review

Standardization Process III

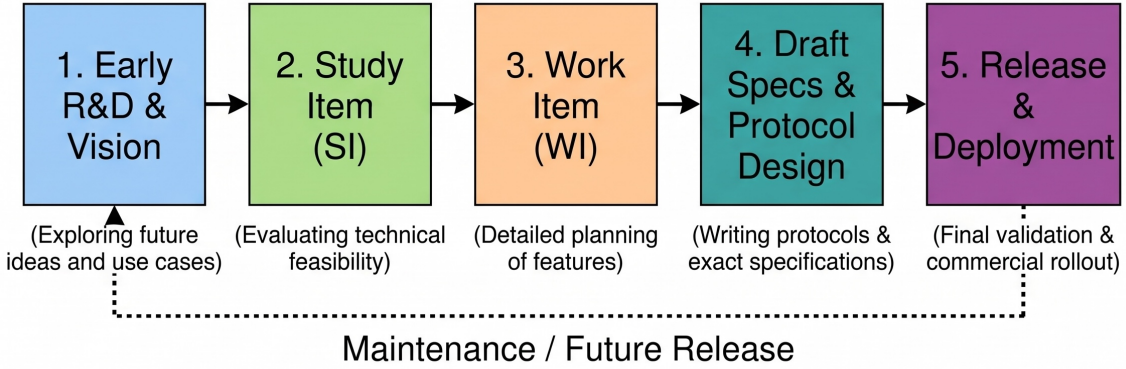


Figure: Standardization Process in 3GPP (simplified) [4]

Standardization Process IV

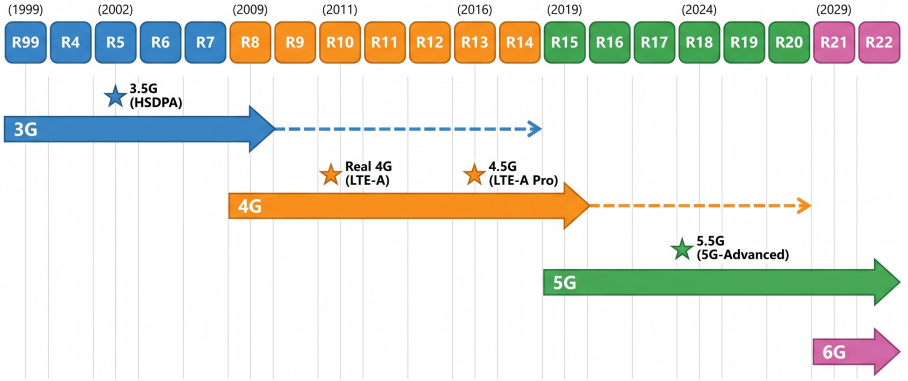


Figure: Releases in 3GPP over Time [4]

Patents I

Standards and patents intersect in radio systems, because standards often rely on patented innovations.

- Patent protects new technical solutions or products
- Grants patent holder monopoly for up to 20 years
- Prohibits making, using, or selling the invention
- However, inventor publicly discloses the invention

Requirements for patentability

- Novelty: Invention must be new
- Inventive step: Invention not obvious to skilled person
- Industrial application: Invention can be made or used

What is a patent?

A patent is an exclusive right granted for an invention.

Patent process (simplified)

1. File application with patent office
2. Formal examination (completeness)
3. Search for prior art
4. Substantive examination (novelty, inventiveness, applicability)
5. Grant or rejection
6. Maintain with annual renewal fees

Patents II

Standard-essential patent (SEP)

- Patents that claim technology necessary to implement a standard
- e.g., channel coding, multiple-input multiple-output (MIMO) schemes in 5G
- Any compliant device must use the patented technology
- Patent holder cannot exclude others from the standard market

Fair, reasonable, and non-discriminatory (FRAND) commitment

- SEP holders commit to license on FRAND terms
- Balances innovation incentives with standard adoption

FRAND principle

- Standardization increases patent value (must-use technology)
- FRAND limits royalty rates
- Tension between patent protection and open standards

References

[1] Treinkvist, "Comparison of the frequency bands defined by NATO, IEEE and ITU," Creative Commons Attribution-Share Alike 4.0 International. [Online]. Available: https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Comparison_of_the_frequency_bands_defined_by_NATO,_IEEE_and_ITU.svg.

[2] National Telecommunications and Information Administration, "United States Frequency Allocations: The Radio Spectrum," U.S. Department of Commerce, Accessed: Oct. 18, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://www.ntia.gov/page/united-states-frequency-allocation-chart.

[3] ISO/IEC, "ISO/IEC Directives, Part 1: Procedures for the technical work," ISO/IEC, Geneva, Switzerland, Standard/Directive ISO/IEC DIR 1, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://www.iso.org/directives-and-policies.html.

[4] Google DeepMind, *Visualizations and Technical Illustrations*, AI-generated images created with Imagen 3 via Gemini, Prompt parameters and visual styling customized for lecture slides, 2026.

Acronyms I

3GPP 3rd Generation Partnership Project. 34, 35, 37, 38, 39

ADC analog-to-digital converter. 22
ANSI American National Standards Institute. 34

BB baseband. 16, 17
BP bandpass. 16

CIR channel impulse response. 11, 12
CTF channel transfer function. 12

DFT discrete Fourier transform. 19, 20, 21
DIN Deutsches Institut für Normung. 34, 35
DVB digital video broadcasting. 3

ETSI European Telecommunications Standards Institute. 33, 34
EU European Union. 33

Acronyms II

FCC Federal Communications Commission. 36

FRAND fair, reasonable, and non-discriminatory. 41

FT Fourier transform. 12, 13, 19, 20

I/Q in-phase and quadrature. 17

ICAS integrated communications and sensing. 5

IDFT inverse discrete Fourier transform. 19, 21

IEC International Electrotechnical Commission. 35, 36

IEEE Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers. 34, 35, 36

IFT inverse Fourier transform. 12

ILS instrument landing system. 30

ISM industrial, scientific and medical. 31

ISO International Organization for Standardization. 34, 35, 36

ITU International Telecommunication Union. 27, 28, 32, 34

LTE Long Term Evolution. 37

Acronyms III

LTI linear time-invariant. 11, 20

MIMO multiple-input multiple-output. 41

SEP standard-essential patent. 41

ULA uniform linear array. 23